

TABLE 6—AVERAGE TREATMENT EFFECTS ON COLLEGE GRADUATION AND LIFE OUTCOMES (ITT)

	Observations	Control mean	Model 1	Model 2
<i>College graduation</i>				
Ever grad. from college	5,037	0.020	0.005 [0.249]	0.004 [0.384]
Ever grad. from two-year college	5,038	0.012	0.005 [0.174]	0.005 [0.175]
Ever grad. from four-year college	5,038	0.007	0.000 [0.939]	−0.001 [0.863]
<i>Employment outcomes</i>				
Ever employed	5,037	0.602	0.011 [0.622]	0.005 [0.822]
Ever employed or college	5,037	0.719	0.007 [0.608]	0.001 [0.951]
Employed or college in 2017	5,037	0.639	0.005 [0.700]	−0.002 [0.877]
<i>Earnings</i>				
Full sample	5,037	5.061	0.141 [0.625]	0.066 [0.866]
Excluding 2017 college enrollees	4,342	5.122	0.112 [0.486]	0.058 [0.727]
Ever incarcerated	5,037	0.033	0.005 [0.414]	0.008 [0.192]
Ever had child during high school	5,037	0.018	−0.002 [0.752]	−0.003 [0.625]
Lagged dependent variable (i)				X
Student covariates and missing indicators (i)				X

Notes: The table reports average treatment effects from OLS estimation of equation (1). Each coefficient is from a separate regression. We report in brackets the *p*-values from RI using 1,000 replications. See additional notes to Table 3.

made two-year college seem more attractive. While the analysis is not adequately powered to test this hypothesis, the pattern is worth noting given the interest in free college among policymakers and the public.

We also see an (imprecisely estimated) pattern of TDP inducing students to shift from out-of-state/ineligible to in-state/eligible colleges and to colleges with lower graduation rates. This result is consistent with findings from prior research (Long, Goldhaber, and Gratz 2021) and could entail reductions in college quality (Cohodes and Goodman 2014).

D. Effects on College Completion and Life Outcomes

Table 6 focuses on college completion and life outcomes, measured up to four years after on-time high school graduation. The top rows show positive point estimates for students graduating from two-year college, though these are imprecise (*p*-value: 0.175). The point estimates suggest that the program increased two-year college completion by a half percentage point, compared with a baseline mean of 1.2 percentage points. Note, too, that the point estimates for four-year college graduation are almost exactly zero.